

choices and give in to the numbness of regularity. In a nutshell, we feel like the team bowling at Pujara: those leg-side glances, back foot cuts, ugly forward nudges seem to be repeating themselves without grace, forever. Any hope that the misery will end is nullified when you look at your family, *“Taking risks are for people who have it sorted - maybe I’ll read entrepreneurship books and further compound my misery”*. But then, there’s a way to pull the cord on this repetitive misery of a video game: be smart with money right from the outset. Investing by utilizing compound interest is how we can make sure, our futures define glory.

Here’s an analogy: Imagine your life as a slice of bread; apply a rich serving of peanut butter to one side and take it close to the mouth; the mountain of deliciousness is the fun that we can have today. It is so inviting that we often fail to recognize that much of the slice is still barren. It is only after we zoom out, we recognize the need to spread evenly across the slice. The point is: the last bite is going to taste awesome if it has some spread on it. So instead of spending everything that we make today, why not spare a little for tomorrow? Just as we all need to *‘live the moment’*, we need to *‘zoom out’* a little and consider our expenses 3 years from now, 5 years from now, 10, 15 and 25 years from now. And while we are at it, go ahead and list the dreams, goals, the places we wish to visit, the cars we want to own, the partner we want to marry etc. The first step in making them a reality is to define them as clearly as possible.

The next step is to realize that our essential expenses in the future are not going to go away. Let’s take the example of the cost of a corner street chai to emphasize why investing is paramount. Priced at ₹7, we can afford it without thinking twice. If I think back to the days when I graduated, it was priced at ₹1.5. The monetary difference maybe small but in terms of yearly increase it’s 10%. Even better, in percentage terms, the past 20 years have seen tea prices increase anywhere between 10% to 13% (on average) depending on your location.

Extrapolating this info for the next 20 years, the estimated price of chai is ₹47 ^[18] in 2037. **An astonishing 571% increase** - just like it has gone from 1997-2017. The reason why we won’t worry about it, is because the increase occurs in baby steps spread over years/decades. When we